history is almost parallel to that of the founder of Buddhism.) During the course of wide travels and wanderings, he preached for about thirty years and attained his final *Nirvāṇa* in 527 B.C. at Pāvāpurī (in modern Behar). Pāvāpurī has become, since then, one of the chief places of Jain pilgrimage. It is a small place in the midst of beautiful surroundings where a number of Jain temples have sprung up. *Diwali,* the annual day of the Hindu illumination, is the day of this pilgrimage. Lord Mahāvīra is supposed to have attained *Nirvāṇa* on this day. The main temple contains the sacred footmarks of Lord Mahāvīra.

THE SECTS OF JAINISM

Jainism is one and undivided so far as its philosophy is concerned. But a little earlier than the Christian era, the Jains began to split on the points of certain rules and regulations for the monks, and the two well-known sects, *Śvetāmbara,* or the white-clad, and the *Digāmbara,* or the sky-clad, were formed.

The points of difference between the two are just minor ones and are: that the *Digāmbaras* hold that a perfect saint goes without food; that he should own nothing, not even clothes, hence the practice of going naked; that salvation is not possible for women. The *Digāmbaras* have no nuns.

Later on, other minor sects called *Sthānakavādī* and *Lūnikās* were also formed, based on idol worship and similar matters. Not believing in a God, or *Avatars,* the Jains are not an idol-worshipping sect, but that has not prevented them from erecting and carving statues in honor of their *Siddhas,* or perfect souls.

CANONICAL LITERATURE OF JAINISM

The preaching of Jainism until long after Lord Mahāvīra, must have been by word of mouth, transmitted from generation to generation. The Jains relied entirely on memory for the propagation and preservation of their faith. They were also called *Nirgranthas,* or those having no books. It is generally believed that after the death of Mahāvīra, knowledge of Jainism as it was first preached gradually began to disappear, and it was only much later that it was again restored.

According to Śvetāmbaras, the canon was reduced to systematization by the council of Pātli-Putra about the end of the fourth century B.C. But it is generally agreed that it was given final shape only after eight hundred years, that is, in A.D. 454. (There is,